

FROM: [REDACTED] INTERNET: [REDACTED]
DATE: 1/9/98 9:41 AM

*Supportive
Scientist*

Re: Re: FACE ON MARS IS FOR REAL! (as if we didn't already know)

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From: [REDACTED] ([REDACTED])
Subject: Re: FACE ON MARS IS FOR REAL! (as if we didn't already know)

>Return-Path: <[REDACTED]>
>From: [REDACTED] ([REDACTED])
>To: [REDACTED]
>Subject: Re: FACE ON MARS IS FOR REAL! (as if we didn't already know)
>Date: Fri, 09 Jan 1998 15:38:30 GMT
>X-Newsreader: Forte Free Agent 1.0.82
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>In alt.ufo.reports, [REDACTED] (doomsday) wrote:
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>>This just in from Nando Times...
>
>
>>Scientist believes Martian 'face' is
>>no accident of nature
>
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>>Copyright © 1998 Nando.net
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>>Nando's special report: 1997 Year in Review
>
>>WASHINGTON (January 8, 1998 00:07 a.m. EST
>>http://[REDACTED]) -- The mysterious "Face on Mars"
>>is not an optical illusion or a natural feature on the Red
>>Planet, a scientist reported Wednesday at a major
>>astronomical conference.
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>>Dr. [REDACTED] reached the conclusion after
>>new studies of the Cydonia region, where
>>strange-looking landforms have excited science fiction
>>and life-on-other-worlds buffs for decades.
>
>>His report, presented at the 191st national meeting of
>>the American Astronomical Society (AAS), attracted

>>unusual attention because sharp new images of the
>>"Face" may soon be available. The National
>>Aeronautics and Space Administration Global
>>Surveyor spacecraft, now orbiting Mars, is scheduled
>>to begin imaging in 1999.

>>Global Surveyor's camera is capable of making images
>>with 30 times the resolution, or sharpness, of the
>>Viking cameras. It can distinguish objects as small as
>>4.6 feet across, and will try to image the "Face."

>>Van Flandern holds a doctorate in astronomy from
>>Yale University. Until 1991, he was chief of the
>>celestial mechanics branch at the U. S. Naval
>>Observatory, a respected astronomy facility. He then
>>founded Meta Research, an organization based here,
>>that fosters research on topics that conflict with
>>mainstream theories in astronomy.

>>The "Face on Mars," he explained, certainly fits that
>>bill. Some people claim that images of the Cydonia
>>region, taken in the 1970s from the Viking spacecraft,
>>show a gigantic human face, a pyramid, and other
>>structures left by some ancient extra-terrestrial
>>civilization.

>>In the eyes of some, the "Face" bears a striking
>>resemblance to the "death masks" that ancient
>>Egyptians used to adorn the sarcophagus of King Tut
>>and other rulers. Indeed, some hint that the "Face"
>>may be part of an immense tomb on the Red Planet.

>>Believers have come up with all kinds of intricate
>>mathematical relationships between the Face and
>>several associated landforms that supposedly prove
>>the structures are artificial.

>>Conspiracy theories, charging NASA and the military
>>with a cover-up, also abound.

>>"The conventional view is that this is all nonsense,"
>>says Dr. Michael C. Malin. He is chief investigator for
>>the Mars Global Surveyor Orbiter Camera.

>>Cydonia, he explained, is a desert-like region that has
>>undergone the same kinds of weathering that carve
>>weird landforms in terrestrial deserts. He regards the
>>features at Cydonia as strictly natural, the result of
>>Martian weathering and erosion.

>>Van Flandern said his study undermines the main
>>argument against an artificial origin for the "Face:" Its
>>apparently random orientation on the Martian surface.

>>"No apparent purpose is served by a face monument
>>looking upward toward space if it is not oriented
>>right-side up and in an attention-getting location with
>>respect to the surface of the planet," he said.

>>On Earth, one such location, visible for great distances

>>from space, might be right on the equator, he indicated.

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>>Van Flandern analyzed data from previous studies
>>showing that the Martian north and south poles
>>occupied a different position in the past. A meteor
>>impact or other cataclysmic event relocated the poles
>>to their current position millions of years ago. He
>>concluded that the "Face" originally was in a much
>>different location.

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>>"It was a great shock to me to discover that the
>>Cydonia area was right on the old Martian equator,"
>>he said.

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>>Further analysis showed that the "Face" is oriented
>>perpendicular to that old equator. The bridge of its
>>"nose" is oriented almost exactly north-to-south.

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>>"This has only about a 1 percent probability of
>>occurring by chance," [REDACTED] said. "The
>>weight of existing evidence appears to have shifted in
>>favor of an artificial origin of the Cydonia complex."

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>>Van Flandern predicted that the Mars Global
>>Surveyor's high-resolution cameras will finally
>>determine whether the "Face" is a natural geologic
>>structure, or something constructed by an earlier
>>civilization.

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>>Almost as an afterthought, he observed to a
>>standing-room-only audience of about 400
>>astronomers, "I suggest that in view of these test
>>results we prepare ourselves for a cultural shock
>>certainly unrivaled in recent times."

>

>>By M [REDACTED] Toledo Blade

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>>--

>>"There shall be a black darkness,
>> There shall be a shaking of the mountain,
>> There shall be a purifying furnace,
>> There shall first be a great wave,
>> And then the shout shall be heard!"

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>>Cad Goddeu (The Battle of the Trees) - Welsh tradition

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>>[http://\[REDACTED\].t/](http://[REDACTED].t/)

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>>----- Posted via Deja News

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